



WHERE SHOULD YOU SOURCE MACAWIIS FROM?

THE BIG PICTURE FOR SOMALIA TEXTILE BUYERS

You're not just buying from a supplier. You're choosing a country.

	 CHINA World's Largest Manufacturer	 INDIA South Asia's Flexible Supplier	 PAKISTAN ★ Recommended for Somalia ★
 MOQ	Very High. 5,000–10,000 pcs minimum. Not flexible for small or trial orders. Forces heavy upfront investment.	Medium. 1,000–3,000 pcs. More flexible than China. Some suppliers accept 500 pcs for repeat buyers.	■ Most Flexible. 500–2,000 pcs minimum. Trial orders welcome. Scale up at your pace without overstock risk.
 LEAD TIME (To Mogadishu)	Slowest. 45–60 days production + 20–25 days sea via multiple transshipment ports. Total: 65–85 days.	Moderate. 30–45 days production + 18–22 days sea via Colombo or Dubai. Total: 48–67 days.	■ Fastest. 21–28 days production + 10–14 days DIRECT Karachi→Mogadishu (Maersk Musafir Express). Total: 31–42 days.
 MACAWIIS QUALITY	■ Mostly synthetic polyester/viscose blends. Somali men dislike the feel. Not genuine checked cotton fabric.	Good cotton lungi available. Limited checked patterns. Quality varies by region — Gujarat is best.	■ Best 100% Cotton. Authentic checked weave from Faisalabad. Exact feel Somali market demands. World-class quality.
 PRICE (CIF Mogadishu)	Low unit price. But long shipping adds \$0.40–0.60/pc freight. Hidden quality issues reduce the advantage.	Mid-range pricing. No direct Mogadishu route — transshipped via Dubai or Colombo raises landed cost.	■ Best Total Value. \$1.20–1.40 CIF Mogadishu. Shortest sea route = lowest freight cost. Best price per quality.
 COMPLIANCE & PAYMENT	OEKO-TEX only from large factories. Small suppliers uncertified. Payment: LC or TT only. No Dahabshiil.	BSCI, OEKO-TEX improving. Better than China. LC / TT payment only. Dahabshiil NOT accepted.	■ OEKO-TEX certified. ISO 9001. WeBOC export certified. ■ Dahabshiil accepted. 50% advance + 50% on B/L copy.
 WEAKNESS For Somalia	Synthetic macawis rejected by Somali buyers. Longest shipping route. Language barrier. No cultural ties.	No direct Mogadishu shipping. Slower transit. Some Somali buyers prefer to avoid Indian suppliers.	■ No major weakness. Smaller factory capacity vs China — covered by flexible MOQ and direct shipping advantage.

THE HONEST SUMMARY

CRITERIA	■■ CHINA	■■ INDIA	■■ PAKISTAN
■ PRICE (CIF Mogadishu)	MEDIUM	MEDIUM	■ BEST VALUE
■ MOQ	VERY HIGH	MEDIUM	■ FLEXIBLE
■ LEAD TIME	SLOWEST	SLOW	■ FASTEST
■ MACAWIIS QUALITY	SYNTHETIC	GOOD	■ BEST COTTON
✓ COMPLIANCE	MEDIUM	GROWING	■ STRONG
■ DAHABSHIIL PAYMENT	■ NO	■ NO	■ YES
■ DIRECT TO MOGADISHU	■ NO	■ NO	■ YES (Maersk)
■ SOMALIA TRUST LEVEL	LOW	MEDIUM	■ HIGH

THE REAL INSIGHT FOR SOMALIA BUYERS — 2026



CHINA

Use only for synthetic garments, electronics or household goods. For Macawis — NOT recommended. Somali market rejects synthetic feel and longest shipping route defeats price advantage.



INDIA

Good for variety and flexibility. But no direct Mogadishu sea route means higher landed cost. Dahabshiil payment not accepted — complicates transactions for Somali buyers.



PAKISTAN ■ BEST CHOICE

Best cotton Macawis quality + fastest sea route to Mogadishu + Dahabshiil accepted + lowest CIF cost. Pakistan is already Somalia's #1 rice supplier — trusted country, smooth customs, strong relationship.

■ Source direct from factory

■ Match country to product

■ Build reliable relationships

■ Diversify your sourcing



AKH LINEN HOUSE

Pakistan Direct Textile Exporter — CIF Mogadishu Available

Bed Linen • Macawis • Towels • Fabric • Prayer Mats

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Pakistan • Direct Factory Prices